



COMPETENCY STANDARD

FOR

ACCOUNTING SERVICES-OUTSOURCING

(ICT SECTOR)

Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP)
Finance Division, Ministry of Finance

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The Competency Standards for Accounting Services-Outsourcing serve as a foundational document for the development of curricula, teaching materials, and assessment tools specifically tailored for the ICT sector. This document ensures that training activities align with industry requirements, enabling individuals who successfully meet the established standards through assessment to become qualified professionals in relevant roles within the sector.

Developed under the Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP), this document addresses the skills requirements critical for Accounting Services-Outsourcing. It is owned by the Finance Division of the Ministry of Finance of the People's Republic of Bangladesh.

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INTRODUCTION

The Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP) has the overall objective of developing a skilled workforce adept at handling new technologies, especially for emerging industries in Bangladesh. It will expand skills training and strengthen the development of the training ecosystem to address the skills requirements of the SICIP-selected industry sectors. The program aims to (i) increase the technology-oriented skilled workforce across emerging and priority sectors, (ii) promote inclusive skilling and upskilling opportunities for women and socially disadvantaged groups, (iii) incentivize industry-university partnerships to nurture innovation capacity and improve industry competitiveness, and (iv) foster skills for climate-resilient manufacturing processes and green technologies. The program is expected to benefit about 220,000 new and existing workers over a 6-year implementation period from 2024-2029.

The SICIP Program has, therefore, taken the initiative to enhance the employability and productivity of trainees by implementing market-responsive and job-focused training programs through public and private training providers. This will require the development of competency standards for each of the occupations/trades which will provide a structured framework in the learning process to guide training providers, ensure consistent training quality, and create an alignment between the skills provided by the training institutes and the needs of the industry.

This competency standard is therefore developed to improve skills following the job roles and skill sets of the occupation and ensure that the required skills are aligned with industry requirements.

The Competency Standard also suggests integration of YouTube or similar digital platforms or downloaded clips into classroom practice to ensure simulated creation of the contents so that learners are exposed to visual demonstrations before classroom instruction or practical session, which aligns with modern learning preference and supports flipped classroom models.

The document details the format, sequencing, wording, and layout of the Competency Standard for an occupation which comprises Units of Competence and its corresponding Elements.

OVERVIEW:

A **Competency Standard** is a written specification of the knowledge, skills, and attitudes required for the performance of a job or occupation or trade corresponding to the standard of performance required in the workplace.

Competency standard:

- provides a consistent and reliable set of components for training, recognizing, and assessing people's skills, and may also have optional support materials.
- enables industry-recognized qualifications to be awarded through direct assessment of workplace competencies
- encourages the development and delivery of flexible training that suits individual and industry requirements
- encourages learning and assessment in a work-related environment which leads to verifiable workplace outcomes.

Competency Standard has been developed by a working group comprised of occupation-specific experts from the industry/institution and relevant consultants of SICIP.

Competency Standards describe the skills, knowledge, and attitude needed to perform effectively in the workplace. Competency Standards acknowledge that people can achieve vocational and technical competency in many ways by emphasizing what the learner can do, not how or where they learned to do it.

With Competency Standards, assessment and training may be conducted at the workplace, at training organization, during regular work, or through work experience, work placement, work simulation or any combination of these.

A Unit of Competency describes a distinct work activity that would normally be undertaken by one person in accordance with industry standards.

Units of Competency are documented in a standard format that comprises:

- Reference to Industry Sector, Occupational Title and Occupational Description
- Unit code
- Unit title
- Unit descriptor
- Elements and performance criteria
- Variables and range statement
- Evidence guides

Together all the parts of a Unit of Competency:

- Describe a work activity
- Guide the assessor in determining whether the candidate is competent.

Identification and validation of units of competency and elements for each occupation were made by experts from various companies in industry consultative workshops.

The ensuing sections of this document comprise a description of the respective occupation with all the key components of a Unit of Competence:

- An overview of all Units of Competence for the occupation and their corresponding duration required for completion of training.
- The Competency Standards that include the Unit of Competency, Unit Descriptor, Elements and Performance Criteria, Range of Variables, Curricular Content Guide, and Assessment Evidence Guide.

Units & Elements at a Glance:**Generic Competencies (20 hrs.)**

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (Hours)
SICIP-ICT-ASO-01-G	Demonstrate Interpersonal and Communication Skills	1 Apply interpersonal skills at the workplace 2 Understand and communicate information and ideas 3 Prepare and present reports and workplace documents	10
SICIP-ICT-ASO-02-G	Support Innovation and Manage Change	1 Identify needs for innovation in the workplace 2 Apply creative approach and solution 3 Support flexible and innovative ways of working 4 Adapt to emerging technological changes and opportunities	10
Total Hour			20 Hrs.

Sector Specific Competencies (20 hrs.)

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (Hours)
SICIP-ICT-ASO-01-S	Comply with Ethical Standards in IT Workplace	1. Uphold the requirements of clients 2. Deliver quality products and services 3. Maintain professionalism at workplace 4. Maintain workplace code of conduct	20
Total Hour			20 Hrs.

Occupation Specific Competencies (180 hrs.)

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (hours)
SICIP-ICT-ASO-01-O	Analyze Client Requirement and plan Engagement	1. Analyze client business structure and operations 2. Identify legal, regulatory, and reporting requirements 3. Review current accounting processes and systems 4. Define outsourcing scope and service expectations 5. Prepare Engagement plan, onboarding and checklist	15
SICIP-ICT-ASO-02-O	Configure and Manage Accounting Software and Digital Tools	1. Select accounting software and tools 2. Set up chart of accounts and key modules 3. Configure system settings, user roles and access 4. Perform Data Migrate, Mapping and validation 5. Test system and prepare initial reports	15
SICIP-ICT-ASO-03-O	Process Bookkeeping and Maintain Financial Records	1. Record, Classify and post financial transactions 2. Maintain general and subsidiary ledgers 3. Manage accounts payable and receivable processes 4. Process payroll transactions and statutory payments 5. Perform bank and ledger reconciliation 6. Conduct AP/AR reconciliation and aging 7. Maintain financial records and audit trails	40
SICIP-ICT-ASO-04-O	Prepare Financial Statements and Perform Financial Analysis	1. Prepare trial balance and adjustment entries 2. Generate income statement and balance sheet 3. Prepare cash flow statements and financial reports 4. Perform financial ratio and variance analysis 5. Create management reports and dashboards 6. Interpret financial data for decisions	25
SICIP-ICT-ASO-05-O	Manage Payroll, Taxation and	1. Calculate payroll and deductions 2. Prepare payroll reports and pay slips	30

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (hours)
	Regulatory Compliance	3. Compute taxes and VAT 4. Prepare tax returns and compliance documents 5. Monitor labor and tax compliance 6. Maintain payroll and tax records	
SICIP-ICT-ASO-06-O	Implement Internal Control and Ensure Data Security	1. Maintain internal controls 2. Manage financial risks and fraud 3. Ensure data security, cybersecurity and confidentiality 4. Secure digital financial records 5. Conduct internal reviews and audits	10
SICIP-ICT-ASO-07-O	Manage Outsourcing Operations and Client Relationships	1. Plan and prioritize accounting tasks 2. Assign duties and monitor performance 3. Communicate financial updates to clients 4. Manage service agreements and deliverables 5. Monitor SLA compliance and resolve issues	20
SICIP-ICT-ASO-08-O	Develop Freelancing and Outsourcing Career	1. Identify freelancing and outsourcing market opportunities 2. Develop professional profile and service portfolio 3. Prepare proposals, Gigs, and acquire clients 4. Manage client communication and long-term relationships 5. Plan career growth and continuous professional development	25
Total Hour			0 Hrs.

COMPETENCY STANDARD: ACCOUNTING SERVICES-OUTSOURCING

The Generic Competencies

Unit of Competency: DEMONSTRATE INTERPERSONAL AND COMMUNICATION SKILLS	Nominal Duration: 10 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-01-G
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitude required to demonstrate interpersonal and communication skills. It specifically includes the tasks of applying interpersonal skills at the workplace, understanding and communicating information and ideas, preparing and presenting reports and workplace documents.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Apply interpersonal skills at the workplace	1.1 <u>Workplace interpersonal skills</u> are interpreted. 1.2 The impacts of interpersonal skills are described. 1.3 Interpersonal skills are performed in accordance with workplace procedures. 1.4 <u>Ways of improving interpersonal skills</u> are identified and followed.
2. Understand and communicate information and ideas	2.1 <u>Communication tools and equipment</u> are operated, and faults are identified and reported. 2.2 Consultative processes is used to collect and convey information. 2.3 Information systems is used to store, retrieve and update information. 2.4 Information data and information are analyzed and interpreted. 2.5 Information is communicated with individuals and groups.
3. Prepare and present reports and workplace documents	3.1 <u>Workplace documents</u> are interpreted. 3.2 Appropriate format for document is used to meet workplace requirements. 3.3 Document is drafted in accordance with workplace procedures. 3.4 Document is edited and presented in a final version appropriate to task.

Range of variables:

Variables	Range (may include but not limited to)
1. Interpersonal skills	1.1 Effective communication 1.2 Cooperation

	1.3 Giving and receiving feedback, feed-forward and professional criticism 1.4 Pressure handling 1.5 Time management 1.6 Acceptance of diversity 1.7 Supporting and encouraging others 1.8 Inclusiveness 1.9 Problem solving 1.10 Negotiation 1.11 Conflict management
2. Ways of improving interpersonal skills	1.1 Cultivate a positive outlook 1.2 Ask trusted friends or colleagues for constructive criticism 1.3 Control emotions 1.4 Observe other positive interpersonal interactions 1.5 Practice active listening 1.6 Seek out opportunities to build relationships 1.7 Practice empathy
3. Communication tools and equipment	1.1 Telephone 1.2 Internet 1.3 Mobile Phone 1.4 Fax machines 1.5 Two-way radio
4. Workplace documents	1.1 Business Letters 1.2 Business Reports 1.3 Transactional Documents 1.4 Memos 1.5 Forms 1.5.1 Memorandum 1.5.2 Requisitioning Form 1.5.3 Personnel Form 1.6 Safety Report Form

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning knowledge	1.1 Interpersonal skills 1.2 Impacts of interpersonal skills 1.3 Consultative processes 1.4 Workplace documents
2. Underpinning skill	1.5 Demonstrating interpersonal skills 1.6 Collecting workplace information 1.7 Analyzing information and ideas 1.8 Preparing workplace documents 1.9 Presenting workplace documents
3. Underpinning Attitudes	1.10 Commitment to occupational health and safety practices 1.11 Promptness in carrying out activities 1.12 Tidiness and timeliness 1.13 Respect to peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in workplace

	1.14 Environmental concern 1.15 Sincerity and honesty
4. Resource implications	The following resources must be provided: 1.1 Workplace (actual or simulated). 1.2 Relevant materials and equipment. 1.3 Relevant specifications or work instructions.

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical aspects of competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 applied interpersonal skills at the workplace 1.2 communicated information and ideas 1.3 prepared and presented reports and workplace documents
2. Methods of assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 1.4 Written test 1.5 Practical Demonstration 1.6 Oral Questioning 1.7 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of assessment	1.8 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 1.9 Assessment should be done by a certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: SUPPORT INNOVATION AND MANAGE CHANGE	Nominal Duration: 10 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-02-G
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills, and attitudes required to support innovation and manage change. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying needs for innovation in the workplace, applying creative approaches and solution, supporting flexible and innovative ways of working and adapting to emerging technological changes and opportunities.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify needs for innovation in the workplace	1.1. The need for <u>innovation</u> in scope of work is recognized 1.2. The value of <u>innovative practices</u> in the workplace is recognized 1.3. Existing way of working in the workplace are interpreted. 1.4. Drawbacks of existing way of working are identified. 1.5. Benefits of change are identified to make it consistent with organizational requirements 1.6. Realistic timelines and targets for implementation of changes are set.
2. Apply creative approach and solution	2.1. Opportunities and creative approaches to implement innovation practices are identified 2.2. Creative approaches of coworkers pertaining to work practices are analyzed and incorporated 2.3. Innovation in accordance with organizational requirements changes are implemented
3. Support flexible and innovative ways of working	3.1. Maximum innovative opportunities are promoted. 3.2. Work assignments to facilitate innovative work skills are organized. 3.3. Team members are provided with guidance and coaching on innovation in the workplace. 3.4. Models of innovative work practice are provided and discussed 3.5. Appropriate environment for learning and innovation is maintained.
4. Adapt to emerging technological changes and opportunities	4.1. Usages of different <u>technologies</u> is determined based on job requirements. 4.2. Appropriate technology is selected as per work specifications. 4.3. Relevant technology is effectively used in carrying out functions.

	4.4. Appropriate implementation tools are used as per task requirement.
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Range of variables:

Variables	Range (may include but not limited to)
1. Innovative practices	1.1. Self-directed support to implement new ideas 1.2. Collaborative arrangement to apply new method of working 1.3. Making scope of work more efficient to use new technology
2. Innovation	1.4. New ideas 1.5. Different ideas 1.6. New methods of doing work 1.7. Use of new Technology
3. Technologies	1.8. Office technology 1.9. Industrial technology 1.10. System technology 1.11. Information technology 1.12. Training technology

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning knowledge	1.1. Definition of innovation 1.2. Current practice in own scope of work 1.3. Workplace procedures 1.4. Support required to generate creative ideas 1.5. Difference between innovation and creativity 1.6. Common effects of change and innovation in the workplace 1.7. Industrial and organizational context of change 1.8. Organization's policies, plans, procedures and structure 1.9. Knowledge of resources required by the organization's operations 1.10. Awareness on technology and its function 1.11. Operating instructions 1.12. Applicable software 1.13. Company policy in relation to relevant technology 1.14. Technology adaptability
2. Underpinning skill	1.1. Identifying resources required for creativity and innovation 1.2. Contributing to brainstorming session 1.3. Identifying issues and concerns of one's scope of work 1.4. Encouraging co-workers to generate and develop ideas 1.5. Evaluating potential obstacles to and opportunities for creativity and innovation 1.6. Sharing of best practices related to innovation and creativity 1.7. Applying relevant technology 1.8. Using update machine and Software

	1.9. Acquiring troubleshooting skills Identifying issues 1.10. Identifying current industry standard diagnostic tools 1.11. Describing common malfunctions and resolutions. 1.12. Determining the root cause of a routine malfunction
3. Underpinning Attitudes	1.13. Commitment to occupational health and safety 1.14. Promptness in carrying out activities 1.15. Sincere and honest to duties 1.16. Eagerness to learn 1.17. Tidiness and timeliness 1.18. Environmental concerns 1.19. Respect for rights of peers and seniors at workplace 1.20. Communication with peers and seniors at workplace
4. Resource implications	The following resources must be provided: 1.21. Workplace (actual or simulated). 1.22. Relevant materials and equipment. 1.23. Relevant specifications or work instructions.

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical aspects of competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified need for innovation in the area of work 1.2 applied creative approach and solution 1.3 supported flexible and innovative ways of working 1.4 adapted to emerging technological changes and opportunities
2. Methods of assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical Demonstration 2.3 Oral Questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

The Sector Specific Competencies

Unit of Competency: COMPLY WITH ETHICAL STANDARDS IN IT WORKPLACE	Nominal Duration: 20 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-01-S
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers knowledge, skills and attitudes required to comply with ethical standards in IT workplace. It specifically includes the tasks of upholding the requirements of clients, delivering quality products and services, maintaining professionalism at workplace and maintaining workplace code of conduct.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined>** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Uphold the requirements of clients	1.1 Clients' requirements are identified. 1.2 Confidentiality of information is maintained in accordance with workplace policies/organizational policies/national legislation. 1.3 Potential conflicts of interest are identified and involved parties of potential conflicts are notified. 1.4 Proprietary rights of client/customer are asserted.
2. Deliver quality products and services	2.1. Products and services are provided according to the clients' requirements. 2.2. Work is completed as per standards. 2.3. Quality processes are implemented when developing products and services.
3. Maintain professionalism at workplace	3.1 Work processes are delivered as per standards. 3.2 Skills, knowledge and qualifications are presented in a professional manner. 3.3 Services and products developed by self and others are delivered as per workplace standard. 3.4 Unbiased and objective information are provided to the clients. 3.5 Realistic estimates for time, cost and delivery of outputs are presented during negotiation.
4. Maintain workplace code of conduct	4.1 Workplace code of conduct is interpreted. 4.2 Workplace code of conduct is followed.

Curricular Content Guide:

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Corporate code of confidentiality of information 1.2 Organizational policies, national legislation and workplace policies in relation to IT sector 1.3 Law and regulations pertaining to proprietary rights 1.4 Quality processes for products and services
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	1.5 Procedure of provided to client information 1.6 Method of estimating for time, cost and delivery products and services 1.7 Workplace code of conduct in IT sector
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Upholding confidentiality of information in accordance with organizational policies, national legislation and workplace policies 2.2 Asserting proprietary rights of clients/customers 2.3 Completing work in accordance with industry and international standards 2.4 Implementing quality processes when developing products and services 2.5 Delivering correctly services and products developed by self and others 2.6 Providing unbiased and objective information to the clients 2.7 Presenting realistic estimates for time, cost and delivery of outputs during negotiation 2.8 Maintaining workplace code of conduct
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 National legislation in relation to IT sector 4.4 Workplace policies, code of conduct & proprietary rights of clients in IT sector 4.5 Relevant tools, equipment and facilities needed to perform the activities 4.6 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide:

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 upheld the requirements of clients/customers 1.2 asserted proprietary rights of clients/customers 1.3 delivered quality products and services 1.4 Implemented quality processes when developing products and services 1.5 maintained professionalism at the workplace 1.6 completed work according to industry and international standards
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	1.7 maintained workplace code of conduct
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral question 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training 3.2 Assessment should be done by a certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

The Occupation Specific Competencies

Unit of Competency: ANALYZE CLIENT REQUIREMENT AND PLAN ENGAGEMENT	Nominal Duration: 15 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-01-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to analyze client requirement and plan engagement. It specifically includes the tasks of analyzing client business structure and operations, identifying legal, regulatory, and reporting requirements, reviewing current accounting processes and systems, defining outsourcing scope and service expectations and preparing engagement plan, onboarding and checklist.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify client business structure and operations	1.1 <u>Type of business structure</u> is identified and documented. 1.2 Nature of business operations is reviewed and analyzed. 1.3 Products and/or services offered by the client are identified and recorded. 1.4 <u>Business record-keeping process</u> is examined and verified. 1.5 Key business activities are clarified in line with client requirements.
2. Identify legal, regulatory, and reporting requirements	2.1 <u>Applicable business laws</u> relevant to the client's operations are identified and reviewed. 2.2 Relevant government rules and regulations are identified and interpreted. 2.3 Industry-specific regulatory requirements are determined and documented. 2.4 <u>Compliance requirements</u> are analyzed in relation to the client's business activities. 2.5 Legal and regulatory information is recorded for engagement planning purposes.
3. Review current accounting processes and systems	3.1 <u>Existing accounting processes</u> are examined and documented. 3.2 <u>Accounting systems</u> currently in use are identified and reviewed. 3.3 Financial recording procedures are analyzed for accuracy and completeness. 3.4 Internal control measures are evaluated for effectiveness. 3.5 Gaps and weaknesses in the accounting system are

	identified and recorded.
4. Define outsourcing scope and service expectations	4.1 <u>Scope of outsourcing services</u> is defined and documented. 4.2 Specific tasks and responsibilities to be outsourced are identified and clarified. 4.3 Service expectations and performance standards are established and agreed upon. 4.4 Deliverables and timelines are determined and recorded. 4.5 Roles and responsibilities of all parties are outlined and confirmed.
5. Prepare Engagement plan, onboarding and checklist	5.1 Engagement objectives, scope, and timelines are defined and recorded. 5.2 Required documents and information are identified and listed. 5.3 An engagement plan is prepared and documented in line with client requirements. 5.4 An onboarding plan is developed and aligned with agreed services. 5.5 A detailed onboarding checklist is prepared and verified.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. Type of business structure	1.1 Sole Proprietorship 1.2 Partnership 1.3 Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) 1.4 Private Limited Company 1.5 Public Limited Company 1.6 Public-Private Partnership (PPP) 1.7 Cooperative 1.8 Non-Profit Organization 1.9 Joint Venture 1.10 Franchise Business
2. Business record-keeping process	2.1 Client data collection and document verification 2.2 Invoice and billing records management 2.3 Accounts payable and accounts receivable tracking 2.4 Cash receipts and payment records 2.5 Payroll and employee expense records 2.6 Bank reconciliation and transaction recording 2.7 Tax documents and compliance records 2.8 Digital bookkeeping software and cloud systems 2.9 Data backup, security, and confidentiality procedures 2.10 Reporting schedules and documentation standards
3. Applicable business laws	3.1 Company and corporate law 3.2 Contract law and service agreements

	3.3 Taxation laws and regulations 3.4 Financial reporting standards and compliance requirements 3.5 Labor and employment laws 3.6 Data protection and privacy regulations 3.7 Intellectual property laws
4. Compliance requirements	4.1 Legal and regulatory compliance 4.2 Tax compliance and statutory filings 4.3 Financial reporting standards compliance 4.4 Contractual and service agreement compliance 4.5 Data protection and confidentiality requirements 4.6 Anti-money laundering (AML) and ethical compliance
5. Existing accounting processes	5.1 Chart of accounts structure 5.2 Accounts payable process 5.3 Accounts receivable process 5.4 Cash and bank management procedures 5.5 Payroll processing system 5.6 Expense tracking and reimbursement process 5.7 Financial reporting workflow
6. Accounting systems	6.1 Manual accounting system 6.2 Computerized accounting system 6.3 Cloud-based accounting system 6.4 Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system 6.5 Industry-specific accounting software 6.6 Outsourced/third-party accounting platform
7. Scope of outsourcing services	7.1 Bookkeeping and data entry services 7.2 Accounts payable and receivable management 7.3 Payroll processing services 7.4 Financial reporting and statement preparation 7.5 Tax preparation and compliance support 7.6 Bank reconciliation services 7.7 Budgeting and financial analysis support 7.8 Virtual Chief Financial Officer (CFO) services 7.9 Audit support and documentation preparation

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of business structures and types of business operations. 1.2 Identify products, services, and key business activities of a client organization. 1.3 Understand business record-keeping processes and documentation practices. 1.4 Identify applicable business laws, regulations, and compliance requirements.
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	1.5 Understand industry regulatory requirements related to business operations. 1.6 Concept of accounting processes and accounting systems used in organizations. 1.7 Understand financial recording procedures and internal control systems. 1.8 Procedures for preparing engagement plans, onboarding plans, and service checklists.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Applying business analysis techniques to identify client business structure and operations. 2.2 Identifying and reviewing products, services, and key business activities of the client. 2.3 Using legal and regulatory information to determine compliance requirements. 2.4 Following relevant business laws, government regulations, and reporting standards. 2.5 Analyzing and documenting existing accounting processes and systems. 2.6 Evaluating internal control practices to identify gaps and weaknesses. 2.7 Defining and documenting outsourcing scope, service tasks, and responsibilities. 2.8 Preparing engagement plans, onboarding plans, and service checklists.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop/notebook 4.3 Facilities needed to perform the activities 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 analyzed client business structure and operations 1.2 identified legal, regulatory, and reporting requirements 1.3 reviewed current accounting processes and systems 1.4 defined outsourcing scope and service expectations
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	1.5 prepared Engagement plan, onboarding and checklist
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: CONFIGURE AND MANAGE ACCOUNTING SOFTWARE AND DIGITAL TOOLS	Nominal Duration: 15 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-02-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to configure and manage accounting software and digital tools. It specifically includes the tasks of selecting accounting software and tools, setting up chart of accounts and key modules, configuring system settings, user roles and access, performing data migrate, mapping and validation and testing system and prepare initial reports.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Select accounting software and tools	1.1 Client requirements for <u>accounting software and tools</u> are identified and analyzed. 1.2 Available accounting software options are reviewed and compared. 1.3 Functional features and system capabilities are evaluated against business needs. 1.4 Compatibility with existing systems is assessed. 1.5 Appropriate accounting software and tools are selected and documented.
2. Set up chart of accounts and key modules	2.1 A chart of accounts is created according to the business structure. 2.2 <u>Account categories</u> are defined. 2.3 Relevant accounts are added and organized in the accounting software. 2.4 <u>Key modules</u> are configured. 2.5 Opening balances and basic settings are entered in the system. 2.6 The configured chart of accounts and modules are reviewed for accuracy and completeness.
3. Configure system settings, user roles and access	3.1 System settings are configured according to business requirements. 3.2 <u>User roles</u> are defined based on job responsibilities. 3.3 Access permissions are assigned to users as per authorization levels. 3.4 Security controls and login settings are established. 3.5 User access and system configurations are reviewed for accuracy and compliance.
4. Perform Data Migrate, Mapping and validation	4.1 Existing financial data are extracted from previous systems or records.

	4.2 Data fields are mapped with the new accounting software structure. 4.3 Financial data are migrated into the accounting system. 4.4 Migrated data are validated to ensure accuracy and completeness. 4.5 Errors or inconsistencies are identified and corrected. 4.6 Final data records are verified and confirmed in the system.
5. Test system and prepare initial reports	5.1 Accounting system is tested to ensure proper functionality. 5.2 Sample transactions are entered to verify system operations. 5.3 System outputs are reviewed for accuracy and completeness. 5.4 Initial financial reports are generated from the system. 5.5 Generated reports are checked to ensure data accuracy and reliability.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Accounting Software and tools	1.1 Desktop-based accounting software 1.1.1 QuickBooks Desktop 1.1.2 Spreadsheet (MS Excel / Google Sheets) 1.2 Cloud-based accounting software 1.2.1 QuickBooks Online 1.2.2 Xero 1.2.3 Zoho Books 1.2.4 MYOB 1.2.5 FreshBooks 1.2.6 Wave Accounting 1.3 ERP accounting modules 1.3.1 SAP ERP (SAP FICO) 1.3.2 Microsoft Dynamics 365 1.3.3 Odoo ERP 1.4 Payroll management tools 1.4.1 ADP Payroll 1.4.2 Gusto 1.4.3 QuickBooks Payroll 1.5 Tax calculation and filing software 1.5.1 TurboTax 1.5.2 XeroTax 1.6 Expense tracking tools 1.6.1 Expensify 1.6.2 Receipt Bank (Dext) 1.6.3 Zoho Expense

	1.7 Collaboration and client communication platforms 1.7.1 Slack 1.7.2 Microsoft Teams 1.7.3 Zoom 1.7.4 Google Workspace
2. Account categories	2.1 Assets 2.1.1 Current assets 2.1.2 Fixed assets/non-current assets 2.2 Liabilities 2.2.1 Current liabilities / short term liabilities 2.2.2 Non-current liabilities/long term liabilities 2.3 Income 2.4 Expenses 2.5 Equity
3. Key modules	3.1 Sales 3.2 Purchase 3.3 Inventory 3.4 Payroll 3.5 Reporting
4. User roles	4.1 System Administrator 4.2 Manager / Supervisor 4.3 Auditor / External accountant / TAX preparer 4.4 Standard User / Staff 4.4.1 Accountant / Finance Officer 4.4.2 Payroll management 4.4.3 Data Entry Operator 4.5 Viewer / Read-only User

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of accounting software and digital accounting tools used in business operations. 1.2 Identify client requirements and software features for selecting suitable accounting systems. 1.3 Understand chart of accounts structure and classification of account categories. 1.4 Procedures for configuring key accounting modules and entering opening balances. 1.5 Concept of system configuration, user roles, and access control in accounting systems. 1.6 Understand data migration and data mapping processes from existing records to new systems. 1.7 Procedures for validating financial data to ensure accuracy and completeness. 1.8 Understand preparation and verification of financial reports generated from accounting software.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Applying business requirements analysis to select appropriate accounting software and tools.

	2.2 Reviewing and comparing accounting software features and system capabilities. 2.3 Configuring key accounting modules, system settings, and opening balances. 2.4 Defining and assigning user roles, permissions, and access controls. 2.5 Performing data extraction, mapping, and migration into accounting systems. 2.6 Validating and correcting migrated financial data for accuracy and completeness. 2.7 Testing accounting system functionality using sample transactions.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop/notebook 4.3 Required learning materials 4.4 Specifications and work instructions

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 selected accounting software and tools 1.2 set up chart of accounts and key modules 1.3 configured system settings, user roles and access 1.4 performed Data Migrate, Mapping and validation 1.5 tested system and prepare initial reports		
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)		
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.		
Unit of Competency:		Nominal Duration:	Unit Code:

PROCESS BOOKKEEPING AND MAINTAIN FINANCIAL RECORDS	40 hrs.	SICIP-ICT-ASO-03-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to process bookkeeping and maintain financial records. It specifically includes the tasks of recording, classify and post financial transactions, maintaining general and subsidiary ledgers, managing accounts payable and receivable processes, processing payroll transactions and statutory payments, performing bank and ledger reconciliation, conducting AP/AR reconciliation and aging and maintaining financial records and audit trails.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Record, Classify and post financial transactions	1.1 Financial transactions are identified from <u>source documents</u> . 1.2 Transactions are recorded in appropriate journals or software systems. 1.3 Transactions are classified under relevant account categories. 1.4 Recorded transactions are posted to the ledger accounts. 1.5 Supporting documents are maintained for verification and audit purposes.
2. Maintain general and subsidiary ledgers	2.1 General ledger accounts are maintained and updated regularly. 2.2 Subsidiary ledgers such as accounts receivable and accounts payable are maintained. 2.3 Ledger entries are posted based on recorded transactions. 2.4 Balances in subsidiary ledgers are reconciled with the general ledger. 2.5 Ledger records are reviewed to ensure accuracy and completeness.
3. Manage accounts payable and receivable processes	3.1 Supplier invoices and bills are received and recorded in the system. 3.2 Accounts payable transactions are verified and processed. 3.3 Customer invoices are prepared and issued. 3.4 Accounts receivable transactions are recorded and monitored. 3.5 Payments received and payments made are recorded and updated in the ledger. 3.6 Outstanding balances are reviewed and followed up as

	required.
4. Process payroll transactions and statutory payments	4.1 <u>Employee payroll data</u> are collected and verified. 4.2 Salaries, allowances, and deductions are calculated. 4.3 Payroll transactions are recorded in the accounting system. 4.4 Statutory deductions and contributions are calculated according to regulations. 4.5 Payroll payments and statutory payments are processed and recorded. 4.6 Payroll records are maintained for reporting and compliance purposes.
5. Perform bank / Credit Card and ledger reconciliation	5.1 Bank / Credit Card statements are collected and reviewed. 5.2 Bank / Credit Card transactions are compared with ledger records. 5.3 Differences and discrepancies are identified and analyzed. 5.4 Adjusting entries are recorded to correct errors or omissions. 5.5 Bank / Credit Card and ledger balances are reconciled and verified. 5.6 Reconciliation reports are prepared and documented.
6. Conduct AP/AR reconciliation and aging	6.1 Accounts payable and accounts receivable records are reviewed. 6.2 Ledger balances are compared with <u>payable and receivable documents.</u> 6.3 Differences and discrepancies are identified and investigated. 6.4 Outstanding balances are categorized according to aging periods. 6.5 Adjustments are recorded where necessary. 6.6 Reconciliation and aging reports are prepared and documented.
7. Maintain financial records and audit trails	7.1 Financial records are maintained in an organized and secure manner. 7.2 Supporting documents are recorded and properly filed. 7.3 Audit trails are maintained for all financial transactions. 7.4 Access and changes to financial records are monitored and documented. 7.5 Financial records are reviewed to ensure completeness and accuracy. 7.6 Records are preserved in accordance with regulatory and organizational requirements.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
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	May include but not limited to:
1. Source documents	1.1 Bank statement 1.2 Cash book 1.3 Purchase order 1.4 Sales order 1.5 Purchase invoice / Bill 1.6 Sale invoice / Bill 1.7 Payment voucher 1.8 Debit note 1.9 Credit note 1.10 Salary sheet
2. Employee payroll data	2.1 Salary or wage structure 2.2 Working hours and attendance records 2.3 Overtime and bonus information 2.4 Allowances and benefits 2.5 Deductions (tax, provident fund, loan, etc.) 2.6 Leave and absence records 2.7 Net salary and payment details 2.8 Statutory contributions and compliance records
3. Payable and receivable documents	3.1 Supplier invoices and bills 3.2 Customer invoices 3.3 Purchase orders 3.4 Sales orders 3.5 Payment vouchers 3.6 Credit notes and debit notes 3.7 Bank statements and payment confirmations 3.8 Supplier and customer statement 3.9 Aging reports of outstanding balances

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of financial transactions, source documents, and accounting records. 1.2 Understand procedures for recording, classifying, and posting transactions in journals and ledgers. 1.3 Identify structure and functions of general and subsidiary ledgers. 1.4 Concept of accounts payable and accounts receivable processes in business operations. 1.5 Understand payroll processing, salary calculations, and statutory deductions. 1.6 Procedures for bank and credit card reconciliation with ledger records. 1.7 Concept of accounts payable and receivable reconciliation and aging analysis. 1.8 Concept of financial record management and audit trail maintenance for compliance and verification.
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2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Identifying and recording financial transactions from source documents. 2.2 Classifying and posting transactions to appropriate journals and ledger accounts. 2.3 Maintaining and updating general ledger and subsidiary ledger records. 2.4 Processing and monitoring accounts payable and accounts receivable transactions. 2.5 Performing payroll calculations and recording payroll and statutory payments. 2.6 Analyzing and correcting discrepancies through adjusting entries. 2.7 Preparing reconciliation and aging reports for payable and receivable accounts. 2.8 Maintaining and organizing financial records, supporting documents, and audit trails.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Specifications and work instructions 4.4 Learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 recorded, Classify and post financial transactions 1.2 maintained general and subsidiary ledgers 1.3 managed accounts payable and receivable processes 1.4 processed payroll transactions and statutory payments 1.5 performed bank and ledger reconciliation 1.6 conducted AP/AR reconciliation and aging 1.7 maintained financial records and audit trails
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration

	2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PREPARE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS AND PERFORM FINANCIAL ANALYSIS	Nominal Duration: 25 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-04-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to preparing financial statements and perform financial analysis. It specifically includes the tasks of Prepare trial balance and adjustment entries, generating income statement and balance sheet, preparing cash flow statements and financial reports, performing financial ratio and variance analysis, creating management reports and dashboards and interpreting financial data for decisions.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Prepare trial balance and adjustment entries	1.1 Ledger balances are collected and reviewed. 1.2 A trial balance is prepared from the ledger accounts. 1.3 Necessary adjustment entries are calculated and recorded. 1.4 Trial balances are verified for accuracy and completeness.
2. Generate income statement and balance sheet	2.1 Financial data are collected from the trial balance. 2.2 Revenue and expense accounts are summarized to prepare the income statement. 2.3 Net profit or loss is calculated and verified. 2.4 Asset, liability, and equity accounts are organized to prepare the balance sheet. 2.5 Income statement and balance sheet are generated using accounting software or manual methods.
3. Prepare cash flow statements and financial reports	3.1 Financial data are collected from accounting records and reports. 3.2 Cash inflows and cash outflows are identified and classified. 3.3 A cash flow statement is prepared according to standard formats. 3.4 Cash flow statement and financial reports are generated from the accounting software or manual method.
4. Perform financial ratio and variance analysis	4.1 Relevant financial data are collected from financial statements. 4.2 <u>Key financial ratios</u> are calculated using standard formulas. 4.3 Variances between actual and expected results are identified. 4.4 Causes of significant variances are analyzed and documented. 4.5 Financial insights are reported to support decision-

	making.
5. Create management reports and dashboards	5.1 Relevant financial data are collected from accounting records. 5.2 Management reports are prepared based on financial information. 5.3 Financial performance indicators are identified and presented in reports. 5.4 Financial data are organized and displayed in dashboard formats. 5.5 Charts and visual summaries are generated to support analysis.
6. Interpret financial data for decisions	6.1 Financial data are reviewed and analyzed from reports and statements. 6.2 Key financial trends and patterns are identified. 6.3 Financial performance indicators are interpreted for decision-making. 6.4 Areas of financial risk or improvement are identified. 6.5 Findings are summarized and presented for management decisions.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Key financial ratios	1.1 Liquidity ratios 1.1.1 Current ratio 1.1.2 Quick ratio 1.2 Profitability ratios 1.2.1 Gross profit margin 1.2.2 Net profit margin 1.2.3 Return on investment 1.3 Efficiency ratios 1.3.1 Inventory turnover 1.3.2 Account receivable turnover 1.4 Solvency ratios 1.4.1 Debt to equity 1.4.2 Interest coverage ratio
2. Management reports	2.1 Financial performance reports 2.2 Budget and variance reports 2.3 Cash flow reports 2.4 Accounts payable and receivable reports 2.5 Sales and revenue reports 2.6 Expense analysis reports 2.7 Profit and loss summaries
3. Financial performance indicators	3.1 Revenue growth 3.2 Return on assets (ROA) 3.3 Return on equity (ROE)

	3.4 Earnings before interest and tax (EBIT) 3.5 Cash flow performance 3.6 Expense ratio 3.7 Cost–benefit performance indicators
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Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of trial balance and adjustment entries in the accounting cycle. 1.2 Understand procedures for preparing trial balance from ledger accounts. 1.3 Identify revenue, expense, asset, liability, and equity accounts for financial statements. 1.4 Concept of income statement and balance sheet preparation. 1.5 Understand preparation of cash flow statements and classification of cash inflows and outflows. 1.6 Concept of financial ratios and variance analysis for evaluating performance. 1.7 Understand preparation of financial and management reports using accounting data. 1.8 Understand interpretation of financial data to support business decision-making.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Preparing and verifying trial balance from ledger accounts. 2.2 Calculating and recording adjustment entries for accurate financial reporting. 2.3 Generating income statement and balance sheet from accounting data. 2.4 Preparing cash flow statements and financial reports using accounting records. 2.5 Using accounting software or manual methods to produce financial statements. 2.6 Calculating and analyzing financial ratios and variances using standard formulas. 2.7 Creating management reports, dashboards, and visual financial summaries. 2.8 Presenting and explaining financial insights to support management decision-making.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in workplace

4. Resource Implications	The Following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Job specifications and work instructions 4.4 Required learning materials
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Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 prepared trial balance and adjustment entries 1.2 generated income statement and balance sheet 1.3 prepared cash flow statements and financial reports 1.4 performed financial ratio and variance analysis 1.5 created management reports and dashboards 1.6 interpreted financial data for decisions
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: MANAGE PAYROLL, TAXATION AND REGULATORY COMPLIANCE	Nominal Duration: 30 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-05-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to manage payroll, taxation and regulatory compliance. It specifically includes the tasks of calculating payroll and deductions, preparing payroll reports and pay slips, computing taxes and VAT, preparing tax returns and compliance documents, monitoring labor and tax compliance and maintaining payroll and tax records.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Calculate payroll and deductions	1.1 Employee payroll data are collected and verified. 1.2 Gross salaries and wages are calculated based on employment records. 1.3 Allowances, overtime, and benefits are calculated according to company policy. 1.4 Statutory and other deductions are calculated in accordance with regulations. 1.5 Net salary amounts are determined after deductions.
2. Prepare payroll reports and pay slips	2.1 Payroll data are compiled from payroll records. 2.2 <u>Payroll reports</u> are generated using the accounting or payroll system. 2.3 Employee pay slips are prepared based on calculated payroll information. 2.4 Details of earnings, deductions, and net pay are included in pay slips.
3. Compute taxes and VAT	3.1 Applicable tax and VAT regulations are identified and reviewed. 3.2 Taxable income and transactions are determined from financial records. 3.3 Tax and VAT amounts are calculated according to current regulations. 3.4 Supporting calculations and records are prepared and maintained.
4. Prepare tax returns and compliance documents	4.1 Required tax information is collected from financial records. 4.2 Tax returns are prepared in accordance with applicable regulations. 4.3 Supporting documents for tax filing are compiled and organized.

	4.4 Prepared tax returns and documents are reviewed for accuracy and completeness. 4.5 Final documents are submitted to the relevant authority within the required deadline.
5. Monitor labor and tax compliance	5.1 Relevant labor laws and tax regulations are reviewed and interpreted. 5.2 Payroll and tax practices are monitored to ensure compliance. 5.3 Required statutory payments and filings are verified. 5.4 Non-compliance issues are identified and documented. 5.5 Corrective actions are recommended to ensure regulatory compliance.
6. Maintain payroll and tax records	6.1 Supporting documents related to payroll and tax payments are filed and stored. 6.2 Records of tax calculations, deductions, and payments are updated regularly. 6.3 Payroll and tax records are preserved according to regulatory requirements.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Payroll reports	1.1 Salary and wage summary reports 1.2 Employee payroll register 1.3 Overtime and bonus reports 1.4 Allowance and deduction reports 1.5 Tax and statutory contribution reports 1.6 Net pay and payment summary reports 1.7 Leave and attendance payroll reports 1.8 Payroll variance and adjustment reports

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of payroll systems, salary structures, and employee compensation. 1.2 Understand procedures for calculating gross salary, allowances, overtime, and benefits. 1.3 Identify statutory deductions and other payroll deductions according to regulations. 1.4 Concept of payroll reports and employee pay slips preparation. 1.5 Understand tax and VAT regulations applicable to business transactions. 1.6 Concept of preparing tax returns and compliance documents. 1.7 Understand labor laws, tax compliance requirements,
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	and statutory payments. 1.8 Concept of maintaining payroll and tax records for reporting and regulatory purposes.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Collecting and verifying employee payroll data and employment records. 2.2 Calculating gross salary, allowances, overtime, and statutory deductions. 2.3 Determining net salary and preparing payroll transactions. 2.4 Calculating taxes and VAT according to applicable regulations. 2.5 Preparing and submitting tax returns and compliance documents. 2.6 Monitoring payroll practices and statutory payments for legal compliance. 2.7 Addressing non-compliance issues in payroll and tax processes. 2.8 Maintaining and updating payroll and tax records with supporting documents.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Learning materials 4.4 Specifications and work instructions

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 calculated payroll and deductions 1.2 prepared payroll reports and pay slips 1.3 computed taxes and VAT 1.4 prepared tax returns and compliance documents 1.5 monitored labor and tax compliance 1.6 maintained payroll and tax records
2. Methods of	Methods of assessment should include:

Assessment	2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: IMPLEMENT INTERNAL CONTROL AND ENSURE DATA SECURITY	Nominal Duration: 10 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-06-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to implement internal control and ensure data security. It specifically includes the tasks of maintaining internal controls, managing financial risks and fraud, ensuring data security, cybersecurity and confidentiality, securing digital financial records and conducting internal reviews and audits.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Maintain internal controls	1.1 Internal control procedures are implemented according to organizational policies. 1.2 Financial transactions are reviewed and authorized through established controls. 1.3 Segregation of duties is maintained to prevent errors and fraud. 1.4 Control records and logs are maintained and updated regularly. 1.5 Internal control practices are monitored to ensure compliance and effectiveness.
2. Manage financial risks and fraud	2.1 <u>Potential financial risks and fraud indicators</u> are identified and assessed. 2.2 Risk control measures are implemented to reduce financial exposure. 2.3 Financial transactions are monitored to detect irregular activities. 2.4 Suspected fraud or anomalies are reported and documented. 2.5 Preventive actions are recommended to strengthen financial controls.
3. Ensure data security, cybersecurity and confidentiality	3.1 Data security measures are implemented to protect financial information. 3.2 User access controls and <u>authentication procedures</u> are maintained. 3.3 Cybersecurity practices are followed to prevent unauthorized access. 3.4 Confidential financial data are handled and stored securely. 3.5 Security breaches or risks are identified and reported.

	3.6 Data protection procedures are reviewed to ensure compliance with security policies.
4. Secure digital financial records	4.1 Digital financial records are stored in secure systems. 4.2 Access to financial records is restricted through user permissions. 4.3 <u>Data backup procedures</u> are implemented to prevent data loss. 4.4 Digital records are protected using appropriate security measures. 4.5 Stored records are monitored to ensure data integrity and confidentiality.
5. Conduct internal reviews and audits	5.1 Internal financial records and processes are reviewed regularly. 5.2 Compliance with internal policies and procedures is verified. 5.3 Audit evidence and supporting documents are examined. 5.4 Errors, discrepancies, or control weaknesses are identified and documented. 5.5 Audit findings and recommendations are reported to management.
6. Maintain internal controls	6.1 Internal control procedures are established and maintained. 6.2 Financial transactions are verified and authorized according to control policies. 6.3 Duties and responsibilities are segregated to reduce risk of errors or fraud. 6.4 Control activities are monitored to ensure compliance with procedures. 6.5 Weaknesses in internal controls are identified and corrective actions are recommended.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. Potential financial risks and fraud indicators	1.1 Unusual or unauthorized transactions 1.2 Duplicate payments or invoices 1.3 Missing or incomplete financial documents 1.4 Unauthorized access to financial records 1.5 Sudden changes in financial data or balances 1.6 Manipulation of financial records or entries 1.7 Delayed or irregular reconciliations 1.8 Unexplained variances in financial reports 1.9 Conflicts of interest in financial transactions

	1.10 Weak internal control procedures
2. Authentication procedures	2.1 Username and password authentication 2.2 One-time password (OTP) verification 2.3 Two-factor authentication (2FA) 2.4 Biometric verification (fingerprint or facial recognition) 2.5 Security token or authentication app verification 2.6 Role-based access authentication 2.7 Login session verification and monitoring
3. Data backup procedures	3.1 Cloud-based backup 3.2 Local server or external storage backup 3.3 Automated scheduled backup 3.4 Manual backup procedures 3.5 Data recovery and restoration procedures

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of internal control systems and their role in financial management. 1.2 Understand procedures for authorization, verification, and segregation of duties to prevent errors and fraud. 1.3 Identify financial risks and fraud indicators in financial transactions. 1.4 Concept of risk management and fraud prevention measures in organizations. 1.5 Understand data security, cybersecurity, and confidentiality practices for financial information. 1.6 Understand secure storage and backup of digital financial records. 1.7 Concept of internal review and audit processes for monitoring compliance. 1.8 Understand identification of control weaknesses and corrective actions to strengthen financial controls.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Applying internal control procedures according to organizational policies. 2.2 Reviewing and authorizing financial transactions through established controls. 2.3 Maintaining segregation of duties to prevent errors and fraud. 2.4 Identifying and assessing financial risks and fraud indicators. 2.5 Monitoring financial transactions to detect irregular activities. 2.6 Managing user access controls, authentication, and confidentiality of financial data. 2.7 Conducting internal reviews and audits to verify compliance with policies.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety

	3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Specifications and work instructions 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 maintained internal controls 1.2 managed financial risks and fraud 1.3 ensured data security, cybersecurity and confidentiality 1.4 secured digital financial records 1.5 conducted internal reviews and audits
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment may include but is not limited to: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: MANAGE OUTSOURCING OPERATIONS AND CLIENT RELATIONSHIPS	Nominal Duration: 20 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-07-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to manage outsourcing operations and client relationships. It specifically includes the tasks of planning and prioritizing accounting tasks, assigning duties and monitor performance, communicating financial updates to clients, managing service agreements and deliverables and monitoring SLA compliance and resolve issues.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Plan and prioritize accounting tasks	1.1 Accounting tasks are identified based on client requirements. 1.2 Tasks are organized and prioritized according to deadlines and importance. 1.3 Work schedules are prepared to ensure timely completion of tasks. 1.4 Responsibilities are assigned according to team roles and capacities. 1.5 Task progress is monitored to ensure efficient workflow.
2. Assign duties and monitor performance	2.1 Duties and responsibilities are assigned according to team roles. 2.2 Work instructions and task requirements are communicated to team members. 2.3 Task performance is monitored against established targets. 2.4 Performance records are maintained for review and evaluation.
3. Communicate financial updates to clients	3.1 Financial updates are prepared based on current financial records. 3.2 Relevant financial information is summarized for client communication. 3.3 Financial reports and updates are shared with clients through appropriate <u>communication channels</u> . 3.4 Client queries related to financial information are addressed promptly. 3.5 Communication records are maintained for future reference.
4. Manage service	4.1 Service agreements are reviewed to identify scope and

agreements and deliverables	responsibilities. 4.2 Service deliverables are defined according to agreed terms. 4.3 Work activities are aligned with service agreement requirements. 4.4 Deliverables are monitored to ensure timely completion. 4.5 Approval of client's service agreements are maintained.
5. Monitor SLA compliance and resolve issues	5.1 Service Level Agreement (SLA) requirements are reviewed and monitored. 5.2 Service performance is evaluated against agreed SLA standards. 5.3 Delays or service issues are identified and documented. 5.4 Corrective actions are taken to resolve identified issues.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. Communication channels	1.1 Email communication 1.2 Telephone or mobile calls 1.3 Video conferencing platforms 1.4 Instant messaging or chat applications 1.5 Online client portals 1.6 Formal letters or written notices 1.7 Meetings or face-to-face discussions 1.8 Internal communication systems

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of task planning and prioritization in accounting and financial services. 1.2 Understand procedures for organizing work schedules and assigning responsibilities. 1.3 Identify roles and responsibilities within an accounting team. 1.4 Concept of monitoring task progress and evaluating team performance. 1.5 Understand preparation and communication of financial updates and reports to clients. 1.6 Identify service agreements, scope of services, and expected deliverables. 1.7 Understand Service Level Agreement (SLA) requirements and compliance monitoring. 1.8 Concept of issue resolution and corrective actions to ensure service quality and timely delivery.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Planning and prioritizing accounting tasks based on client

	requirements and deadlines. 2.2 Organizing work schedules and assigning responsibilities according to team roles. 2.3 Monitoring task progress and team performance against established targets. 2.4 Communicating financial updates and reports to clients through appropriate channels. 2.5 Reviewing and managing service agreements and defined deliverables. 2.6 Monitoring Service Level Agreement (SLA) compliance and service performance. 2.7 Resolving service issues and implementing corrective actions.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Specifications and work instructions 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 planed and prioritized accounting tasks 1.2 assigned duties and monitored performance 1.3 communicated financial updates to clients 1.4 managed service agreements and deliverables 1.5 monitored SLA compliance and resolve issues
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment may include but is not limited to: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified

	assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.
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Unit of Competency: DEVELOP FREELANCING AND OUTSOURCING CAREER	Nominal Duration: 25 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ASO-08-O
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Unit Descriptor:

This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to develop freelancing and outsourcing career. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying freelancing and outsourcing market opportunities, developing professional profile and service portfolio, preparing proposals, Gigs, and acquire clients, managing client communication and long-term relationships, and planning career growth and continuous professional development.

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify freelancing and outsourcing market opportunities	1.1 <u>Freelancing and outsourcing markets</u> are researched to identify service demand. 1.2 Competition and pricing strategies in the market are analyzed. 1.3 Profitable niches and service areas are identified. 1.4 Required skills and competencies for outsourcing work are identified. 1.5 Client needs and market trends are reviewed. 1.6 Potential market opportunities are documented for service positioning.
2. Develop professional profile and service portfolio	2.1 A professional profile is created on relevant freelancing platforms. 2.2 Skills, qualifications, and work experience are presented in the profile. 2.3 A profile introduction video is prepared to present services and capabilities. 2.4 A service portfolio is developed to showcase completed work and skills. 2.5 Portfolio items and profile information are reviewed and updated regularly.
3. Prepare proposals, Gigs, and acquire clients	3.1 Service gigs are created and published on freelancing platforms. 3.2 Gig descriptions, pricing, and <u>service packages</u> are clearly defined. 3.3 Client profiles and ratings are reviewed before responding to job postings. 3.4 Job requirements are analyzed before preparing proposals. 3.5 Client proposals are prepared and submitted through

	appropriate freelancing platforms. 3.6 Client communications are maintained to secure projects and build trust.
4. Manage client communication and long-term relationships	4.1 Client communications are conducted through appropriate channels. 4.2 Client requirements and feedback are received and documented. 4.3 Project updates and service information are communicated regularly. 4.4 Client concerns or issues are addressed promptly. 4.5 Long-term client relationships are maintained through professional service and follow-up.
5. Plan career growth and continuous professional development	5.1 <u>Career goals and development needs</u> are identified and documented. 5.2 Required skills and competencies are reviewed against market demands. 5.3 Learning and training opportunities are identified for skill improvement. 5.4 <u>Professional development activities</u> are planned and scheduled.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Freelancing and outsourcing markets	1.1 Upwork 1.2 Fiverr 1.3 Freelancer 1.4 PeoplePerHour 1.5 Toptal 1.6 Guru 1.7 Truelancer 1.8 LinkedIn Marketplace / LinkedIn Services
2. Service packages	2.1 Basic service package 2.2 Standard service package 2.3 Premium service package 2.4 Custom service package 2.5 Hourly service package 2.6 Project-based service package 2.7 Monthly retainer package 2.8 Enterprise or advanced service package
3. Career goals and development needs	3.1 Short-term career goals 3.2 Long-term career goals 3.3 Technical skill development needs

	3.4 Industry certification goals 3.5 Training and learning priorities 3.6 Career progression or promotion goals 3.7 Personal development objectives
4. Professional development activities	4.1 Skills training and upskilling programs 4.2 Professional certification preparation 4.3 Networking and professional community participation 4.4 Knowledge sharing and peer learning 4.5 Industry research and self-study 4.6 Career planning and performance review activities

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of freelancing and outsourcing markets and global service demand. 1.2 Identify market opportunities, profitable niches, and client needs. 1.3 Understand competition, pricing strategies, and market trends in freelancing platforms. 1.4 Concept of professional profiles and service portfolios for online platforms. 1.5 Identify client requirements and project expectations before submitting proposals. 1.6 Concept of professional client communication and relationship management. 1.7 Understand strategies for building long-term client relationships and trust. 1.8 Concept of career planning and continuous professional development in freelancing.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Researching and analyzing freelancing and outsourcing markets to identify service opportunities. 2.2 Evaluating competition, pricing strategies, and profitable service niches. 2.3 Developing professional profiles and service portfolios on freelancing platforms. 2.4 Presenting skills, experience, and services through profile content and introduction videos. 2.5 Creating and publishing service gigs, pricing packages, and service descriptions. 2.6 Communicating and negotiating with clients to secure projects and build trust. 2.7 Managing client communication, feedback, and long-term professional relationships. 2.8 Planning and pursuing continuous learning and professional development for career growth.

3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Specifications and work instructions 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified freelancing and outsourcing market opportunities 1.2 developed professional profile and service portfolio 1.3 prepared proposals, Gigs, and acquire clients 1.4 managed client communication and long-term relationships 1.5 planed career growth and continuous professional development
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment may include but is not limited to: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

END OF COMPETENCY STANDARD

Workshop/Lab Facility Standard

Course Name:	Accounting Services-Outsourcing
Number of Trainees:	25

Course-wise Training Space (Theoretical Classroom, Workshop/ Lab/ Classroom cum Workshop):

- Classroom cum workshop – 500 sft (46 sqm)

Major Training Equipment and Training Facilities:

Sl. No.	Major Equipment and Training facilities	Required facilities
1.	Computer/Laptop	01
2.	Printer	01
3.	Scanner	01
4.	Computers/Laptop: (Minimum Intel Core i3 processor (8 th Gen), 8GB RAM (16GB preferred), 256GB SSD/HDD storage, High-resolution monitors (19/20-inch minimum, with color accuracy).	25
5.	Projector: High-resolution projector (HD or 4K) for instructor presentations, large screen for the room to ensure visibility for all trainees.	01
6.	High-Speed Internet Router	01
7.	LAN Networking System (Cables and Ports)	01
8.	UPS (Uninterruptible Power Supply)	25
9.	External Hard Drive / Backup Storage	02
10.	Projection Screen	01
11.	Whiteboard / Smart Board	01
12.	Computer Tables	25
13.	Computer Chairs	25
14.	Trainer Table and Chair	02

The following conditions must be fulfilled –

- The institute shall not use the same facilities for any other projects/organizations offering a similar course.
- The institute must provide sufficient evidence to prove ownership of the proposed training equipment.

The list denotes the minimum training equipment and facility required to effectively conduct training for a specific course. Additionally, the institute must ensure that all other necessary training tools, equipment, and furniture are available to meet the requirement of competency standards (CS) provided by SICIP.

For the operation of training course on Accounting Services-Outsourcing, the institute must ensure the availability of at least 80% of the major training equipment and training facilities (according to the CS) to be eligible for SICIP training delivery. If the score is below 80%, the remaining equipment and facilities need to be installed before the commencement of the training.

The institute will also provide all other hand tools and power tools as per CS for 25 trainees. Also, they will arrange adequate seating arrangement and classroom setup for the 25 trainees.